

The First Report

Queen Mother:

I write this report en route to a purported settlement on a volcanic mountain on the planet known as Venus. My companions and I are chasing a lead into knowledge about Ahamkara—a species of shape-changing dragons that appear to have abilities beyond paracausal in nature. While I am sure their abilities are known to you already, should I encounter any information that seems it would be useful, I will endeavor to report it. For now, preliminary reports indicate that they can grant wishes, writing the request into the fabric of reality. It appears they take a toll from the requester, however; these wishes are not gifts, but rather transactions—the price of which is unknown to the one bringing the wish.

In relation to my mission, I have encountered a pair of guardians; I believe you would enjoy their presence—or at least being able to toy with them. At the moment, they have allowed me to accompany them, although they do not yet know my identity. I shall leave their specifics below and will continue to update their entries as I uncover more information.

Aiat.

Aiash ur-Sathona

Ren-3

Species: Exo

Class: Hunter

Preferred Paracausal Attunement: ???

Threat Level: Medium*

Ren is an average-sized Exo Guardian. On the surface, he appears to be an ordinary Hunter, but this is misleading. He lost his Light abilities after he wished upon an Ahamkara and, instead, gained paracausal abilities derived from the Darkness in a form I would not have thought possible. This “Strand” ability, as he calls it, typically materializes in the form of green strings—a versatile power that he wields to great effect, unraveling enemies as though they were spools of thread and swinging through the air at speeds that dwarf the fastest of Wizards. He appears to hold no issues with the Darkness—he even seemed pleased when he first witnessed my use of Hive magic in a fight. While I have no reason to assume he would attempt to kill me at the moment, should a fight occur between us, my assessment is that I would likely win; however, the unknown and unpredictable nature of his abilities, combined with his movement, make me hesitant to say that with any certainty. Ideally, a fight between us will never happen—of those I

have met so far, he seems most likely to be a persistent ally. I have hopes for a continued partnership with him.

Flicker

Species: Ghost

Guardian: Ren-3

Threat Level: Low

Flicker is the Ghost belonging to Ren-3. While I have not seen much of him, he seems to be friendly to all others. He seems particularly friendly with Grav (see below). Given his relation to Ren, I also believe he has few qualms about the Darkness. He has welcomed me freely into the group and seems unlikely to betray me without provocation. If the two of us were to fight, for some unimaginable reason, I have no reason to assume he would pose any sort of threat to me—he has exhibited no combat abilities so far, which seems to be standard for most Ghosts. An unfortunate design flaw, by my assessment.

Valerie

Species: Awoken

Class: Warlock

Preferred Paracausal Attunement: Void

Threat Level: High*

Valerie is an average-sized Awoken Guardian. She appears to be a member of the “Praxic Order,” a group of well-established Guardians who value a specific set of rules by which they must abide. This group highly venerates the Light, to the point that they will wage war against those who support the Darkness. She and Ren notably share history, wherein she once killed him for speaking in support of using the Darkness. Her straightforward demeanor and willingness to solve problems with violence is somewhat refreshing, although it does create a potential issue for me. For now, she appears willing to put up with Ren and I, though she watches us closely and will not hesitate to strike out against us if she feels we are stepping too far out of line. While she was clearly unhappy with my use of Hive magic, she has allowed its limited use for the purposes of survival and combat—likely due to Ren’s presence; she could not justify killing me for my tools while Ren wielded a purer form of Darkness and was allowed to live. It is unclear how long this uneasy truce will hold, but being able to sway her into becoming an ally could prove a worthy effort. I have marked her as a high-level threat for now, primarily due to the volatility of our current relationship. It is much more likely that I would end up fighting her; while her skill with weapons seems much lower than Ren’s or mine, her mastery of Void light is incredible and would likely pose an issue for me. If I were to make an informed decision, I believe I would survive the encounter—but it may be very close.

Grav

Species: Ghost

Guardian: Valerie

Threat Level: Low

Grav is the Ghost associated with Valerie. She seems slightly less outgoing than Flicker, but the two have a sense of camaraderie that belies their Guardians' relationship. While Valerie seems more hot-headed and single-minded, Grav is calmer and has a wider array of knowledge. Her friendship with Valerie enables her to speak logic and help cool her Guardian off—it would not surprise me if Grav was the primary reason Valerie hadn't yet tried to kill Ren and I. She would likely be a good ally to make—logical and influential, she may prove to be the key to a more permanent alliance with Valerie. As with Flicker, I doubt I would ever come to blows with Grav, but I have doubts she could best me in combat and would pose no threat to me physically. Perhaps I should look into ways to augment the Ghosts with weapons—a blade or two may provide them with *some* method of self-defense, after all.